



YOU ARE **10 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

205 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The external ear is now more clearly seen as it makes its way to its final position. The eyes are also much closer to their final position and the neck continues to lengthen. The baby will often bring his hands up to his mouth, providing important sensory feedback.

“Healthy teeth and gums are essential in pregnancy, so brush thoroughly and make regular dental appointments.”

Make sure you're taking care of your teeth and gums. The hormone progesterone causes gum tissue to soften and it's therefore more likely to bleed when brushed and to become infected.

It's even more important than usual to brush your teeth regularly and use dental floss at least once a day. Think about your diet, too. Avoid having sugary drinks and foods, and if you are suffering from morning sickness rinse out your mouth with water after vomiting to remove the acid from your stomach.

To keep your mouth healthy during your pregnancy, brush your teeth twice a day with a fluoride toothpaste and floss your teeth every day. Be sure to see your dentist regularly for cleanings as recommended. If you need antibiotics to treat an infection, make sure to remind your dentist you are pregnant so that medications that are safe in pregnancy are prescribed.

If your dentist needs to take X-rays of your mouth, he or she will protect your baby by covering your abdomen with a lead apron.

A TOOTH FOR EVERY CHILD

A US study found that, on average, those with one child were missing two or three teeth, and those with four or more children were missing between four and eight teeth.

So the old wives' tale that "You will lose a tooth for every child" could have some basis in truth. It might be because of the hormonal changes occurring during pregnancy that can cause [gum disease](#).

ASK A DOCTOR

Why am I getting more vaginal discharge since being pregnant? In pregnancy, the layer of muscle in the vagina thickens, and cells lining the vagina multiply in response to an increase in